

F5 Daily Briefing - Thursday, August 27, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

23

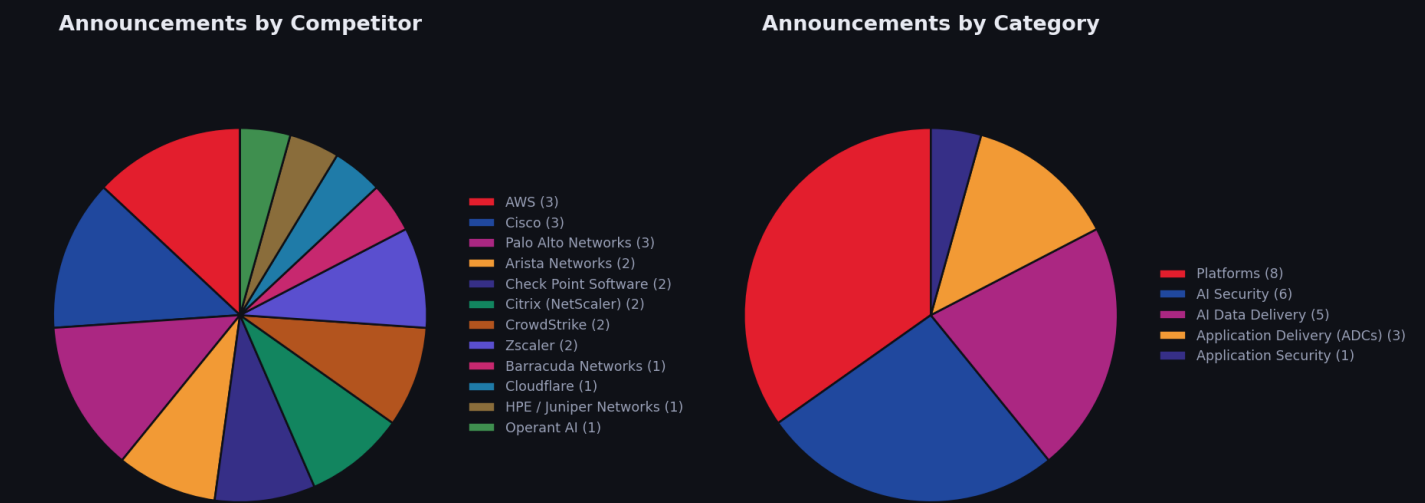
ANNOUNCEMENTS

12

ACTIVE

5

ACTIVE CATEGORIES



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (23)

PRODUCT LAUNCH

AWS

2026-08-27

AWS Brings OpenAI Models to Amazon Bedrock for In-Country Inferencing in India

AWS announced OpenAI models on Amazon Bedrock with in-country inferencing in India, keeping prompt and completion traffic inside Indian infrastructure. The option targets regulated industries such as financial services, healthcare and public sector that need data residency guarantees while using frontier models, and it pairs local inference endpoints with Bedrock's existing governance, logging and guardrail tooling. It extends AWS's pattern of turning model access into a regionally routed, compliance-aware delivery service.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/machine-learning/introducing-openai-models-on-amazon-bedrock-for-in-country-inferencing-in-india/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

AWS

2026-08-27

AWS Elastic Disaster Recovery Introduces Recovery Plans for Orchestrated Application Recovery

AWS added Recovery Plans to Elastic Disaster Recovery, letting customers define ordered, application-aware recovery sequences rather than recovering servers individually. Teams can group dependent workloads, set launch order and validation steps, and execute or drill a coordinated failover from a single plan. The feature targets enterprises with multi-tier applications that need predictable RTO and repeatable DR testing across AWS Regions.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/08/elastic-disaster-recovery-plans/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

AWS

2026-08-27

Amazon Bedrock AgentCore Expands to Two New AWS Regions

AWS expanded Amazon Bedrock AgentCore availability to two additional Regions, widening where customers can run production agent workloads on the framework-agnostic AgentCore runtime with built-in memory, gateway, identity and observability. The expansion reduces latency for agent traffic and helps customers meet in-Region data residency requirements for agentic AI deployments. AgentCore serves as AWS's managed serving and routing layer for AI agents, competing directly with third-party AI gateway offerings.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/08/bedrock-agentcore-two-new-regions/>

ANALYST REPORT**Arista Networks**

2026-08-27

Arista's AI Fabrics Now Serve 100+ Customers as Company Raises 2026 Guidance to \$12.6B

Coverage of Arista's Q2 2026 results details how Etherlink AI fabric deployments have grown from single-digit customers in 2024 to more than 100 cumulative customers, driving a record \$3.04B quarter (up 37.7% YoY) and a third full-year guidance raise to roughly \$12.6B. Management now targets at least \$3.6B in AI fabrics revenue for 2026 and lifted supply-chain commitments to \$9.7B to secure memory and components. A liquid-cooled 1.6 Tbps 7060X-E7 platform is in trials for 2027 production.

Source: <https://www.tikr.com/blog/arista-networks-ai-fabrics-now-serve-100-customers-heres-the-story-behind-the-guidance-raise>

THREAT INTEL**Arista Networks**

2026-08-27

CISA Flags Actively Exploited Arista EOS Flaw That Arista Has Declined to Patch

A CISA alert covering actively exploited flaws in Cisco SD-WAN, Chrome V8 and Arista EOS puts Arista under scrutiny over CVE-2026-7473, disclosed by Comcast researchers. Rather than shipping a patch, Arista recommends mitigations such as applying ACLs on upstream or affected devices, citing the risk of breaking existing customer configurations. The coverage frames Arista's no-patch stance as a broader industry question about prioritizing network stability over immediate security remediation in enterprise infrastructure.

Source: <https://paleon.org/article/cisa-s-critical-alert-cisco-chrome-and-arista-flaws-exploited-what-you-need-to-know>

THREAT INTEL**Barracuda Networks**

2026-08-27

Barracuda Research Details GlobalProtect Scanning, VPN Credential Harvesting and ScreenConnect Abuse

Barracuda's latest SOC threat-hunting findings cover three active patterns: mass scanning of exposed Palo Alto GlobalProtect deployments following disclosure of CVE-2026-0257, credential-stuffing against an exposed Fortinet VPN aided by a misconfigured firewall that opened SSL VPN, RDP and Telnet to the internet, and abuse of ScreenConnect for unattended persistence, with binaries dropped in system32 and beaconing to suspicious domains. Barracuda recommends patching public-facing remote access, tightening firewall rules and monitoring legitimate remote-management tooling.

Source: <https://cxotoday.com/cybersecurity/the-latest-barracuda-research-findings-on-threats-facing-businesses/>

PARTNERSHIP**Check Point Software**

2026-08-27

Check Point Backs OpenAI's Call for Collective Action on Cyber Defense

Check Point publicly endorsed OpenAI's open letter and action plan calling for industry-wide collaboration on AI-era cyber defense. The commitment covers expanding access to cyber AI models and security assessments, sharing threat intelligence, collaborating with governments and security partners, and contributing practical tooling and verification processes. Check Point framed the effort as concrete near-term steps to close defensive gaps as attackers adopt AI, and pledged its own tools and expertise to the joint program.

Source: <https://blog.checkpoint.com/ai-security/check-point-supports-openais-call-for-collective-action-on-cyber-defense/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Check Point Software**

2026-08-27

Check Point Launches Contextual AI Agent Protection That Blocks Harmful Actions Before Execution

Check Point introduced runtime contextual protection for AI agents that evaluates an agent's full task context, user intent, prior actions and encountered content instead of relying on predefined rules or signatures. It detects and blocks data exfiltration, destructive operations, indirect prompt injection and intent-misaligned actions before they execute, adding roughly 50ms of latency. The capability is already in production and rolling out to Check Point AI Security customers through Workforce AI Security, native AI Gateway integrations, and direct APIs and plug-ins.

Source: <https://blog.checkpoint.com/ai-security/stopping-the-ai-agent-actions-no-rule-could-see-coming/>

ANNOUNCEMENT**Cisco**

2026-08-27

Cisco Deploys Custom AI Agent "MyAgent" to Its Entire 90,000-Person Workforce

Cisco rolled out MyAgent, a purpose-built internal AI agent, to all approximately 90,000 employees, making agentic AI a default part of daily workflows rather than a pilot. The deployment is positioned as proof of enterprise-scale agentic adoption, handling knowledge retrieval and task automation across internal systems, and doubles as a reference story for Cisco's broader AI platform and agentic management push. It follows Cisco's recent moves to agentify its security and cloud management suite behind a single pane of glass.

Source: <https://www.pymnts.com/news/artificial-intelligence/2026/cisco-deploys-custom-ai-agent-to-entire-90000-person-workforce/>

ANALYST REPORT**Cisco**

2026-08-27

Cisco Named a Leader in The Forrester Wave: Microsegmentation Solutions, Q3 2026

Cisco was named a Leader in The Forrester Wave: Microsegmentation Solutions, Q3 2026, with Cisco Secure Workload recognized for hybrid agent-based and agentless enforcement across multi-cloud environments. Forrester highlighted east-west segmentation, policy-driven distributed enforcement, eBPF-based low-overhead visibility, and support spanning Cisco ACI, Secure Firewall, and upcoming N9300 switches. Cisco frames microsegmentation as mission-critical for limiting lateral movement and blast radius as AI-powered attacks accelerate, positioning unified visibility, policy administration, and enforcement across on-premises and cloud estates.

Source: <https://www.infosectoday.io/microsegmentations-moment-is-now-cisco-named-a-leader-in-the-forrester-wave-microsegmentation-solutions/>

ANNOUNCEMENT**Cisco**

2026-08-27

Cisco Targets HPE and Dell with 14-Day Server Price Guarantee

Cisco introduced a 14-day server price guarantee aimed squarely at HPE and Dell, promising locked-in quoted pricing for a two-week window as enterprises weigh large AI infrastructure purchases. The move is a go-to-market play to reduce procurement friction and quote volatility during AI compute buildouts, keeping Cisco UCS in contention during extended evaluation cycles. It arrives alongside Cisco's expanded Secure AI Factory with NVIDIA and Supermicro rack-scale compute, reinforcing its push to be the full-stack AI infrastructure supplier.

Source: <https://www.sdxcentral.com/news/cisco-takes-aim-at-hpe-dell-14-day-server-price-guarantee/>

THREAT INTEL**Citrix (NetScaler)**

2026-08-27

CISA Orders Federal Agencies to Patch Actively Exploited NetScaler ADC and Gateway RCE Flaw by August 29

CISA directed U.S. federal agencies to patch Citrix NetScaler ADC and NetScaler Gateway appliances against CVE-2026-8452 by August 29, 2026, after adding the flaw to its Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog under Binding Operational Directive 26-04. Citrix originally characterized the memory overflow as denial-of-service only, but researchers demonstrated pre-authentication remote code execution as root, and exploitation is now confirmed in the wild against internet-exposed Gateway VPN and AAA virtual servers. Citrix also flagged related critical NetScaler flaws CVE-2026-19489 and CVE-2026-19490.

Source: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/cisa-hackers-now-exploiting-citrix-netscaler-rce-flaw-in-attacks/>

THREAT INTEL**Citrix (NetScaler)**

2026-08-27

Detection and Remediation Guide Published for NetScaler CVE-2026-8452 KEV Listing

Security researchers published a detection and remediation guide for CVE-2026-8452, a memory buffer overflow in Citrix NetScaler ADC and NetScaler Gateway that enables unauthenticated remote code execution and memory disclosure through packet processing and HTTP services. The guide covers exposed management and gateway interfaces, confirmed active exploitation indicators including web shells such as x.php and z.php, and priority-one patching to the fixed builds in Citrix's security bulletin. It affects VPX and MPX deployments used for enterprise application delivery.

Source: <https://securityarsenal.com/blog/cve-2026-8452-citrix-netscaler-added-to-cisa-kev-alongside-five-legacy-flaws-detection-and-remediation-guide>

ANNOUNCEMENT**Cloudflare**

2026-08-27

Cloudflare Reclaims 100 Terabytes of Memory by Optimizing the 1.1.1.1 DNS Cache

Cloudflare detailed a rewrite of the cache entry layout behind its 1.1.1.1 public resolver, cutting per-entry memory use by 56% and freeing roughly 100 terabytes of RAM across its global fleet. The work was implemented in Rust as part of the Big Pineapple DNS stack, letting the same hardware hold far more cached records and improving hit rates and resolution efficiency at edge locations. The post positions resolver efficiency as a lever for lower latency and better capacity headroom.

Source: <https://blog.cloudflare.com/dns-cache-memory-optimization-1111/>

EARNINGS**CrowdStrike**

2026-08-27

CrowdStrike Stock Surges 20% After Record Q2 FY2027 Results and Raised Guidance

CrowdStrike shares jumped about 20% to a fresh 52-week high after reporting record fiscal Q2 2027 results: revenue of \$1.47 billion, ending ARR of \$5.84 billion up 25% year over year, and a record \$333 million in net new ARR, up 51%. Falcon Flex commitments passed \$2.29 billion. Management raised full-year net new ARR growth guidance to roughly 34% at the midpoint, and CEO George Kurtz called it the best quarter in company history. Analysts flagged valuation concerns despite the beat.

Source: <https://seekingalpha.com/news/4637710-crowdstrike-surges-20-after-q2-beat>

ANNOUNCEMENT**CrowdStrike**

2026-08-27

Kurtz Positions CrowdStrike as "Cybersecurity's Infrastructure Layer" for the AI Era

CrowdStrike CEO George Kurtz argued that AI is compressing the time attackers need to find and exploit vulnerabilities, exposing gaps even at heavily funded security organizations and outrunning legacy tooling. He positioned Falcon as cybersecurity's infrastructure layer for the AI era, citing agentic AI detection and response, Continuous Identity for AI Agents, and securing AI environments as the company's largest market opportunity. More AI security detail is expected at next week's Fal.Con in Las Vegas.

Source: <https://www.crn.com/news/security/2026/crowdstrike-is-cybersecurity-s-infrastructure-layer-for-ai-era-ceo-george-kurtz>

ANNOUNCEMENT**HPE / Juniper Networks**

2026-08-27

HPE to Showcase Sovereign AI, Self-Driving Networking and AI Factory Portfolio at LEAP 2026

HPE will present its sovereign AI, autonomous networking and hybrid cloud portfolio at LEAP 2026 in Riyadh (Aug 31-Sep 3). Highlights include HPE AI Factory with NVIDIA for large-scale and sovereign AI infrastructure, self-driving networking that combines HPE Aruba and HPE Juniper technology to detect, diagnose and resolve issues in real time across campus, branch and WAN, and Cray GX5000 supercomputing with direct liquid cooling. HPE Private Cloud AI, cyber resilience and AI-ready data and storage round out the showcase.

Source: <https://www.tradearabia.com/News/467029/HPE-to-showcase-sovereign-AI-hybrid-cloud-tech-at-top-Saudi-event/IT>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Operant AI**

2026-08-27

Operant AI Launches Semantic Firewall to Enforce AI Agent Intent in Real Time

Operant AI launched the Operant Semantic Firewall, an inline runtime control that interprets the intent behind every prompt, tool call, command, and data movement, then allows, blocks, or redacts the action before it executes. Positioned as the first in-perimeter enforcement point for the full agent loop, it targets jailbreaks, malicious code execution, privilege escalation, and data exfiltration that pattern-based defenses miss. The release also adds Code Intent Guard, live Browser AI protection for ChatGPT, Claude, Copilot, and Gemini sessions, and an Operant Token Meter for token spend visibility.

Source: <https://www.streetinsider.com/Globe+Newswire/Operant+AI+Launches+Semantic+Firewall+to+Enforce+AI+Agent+Intent+in+Real+Time/26984538.html>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Palo Alto Networks**

2026-08-27

Cortex Cloud Adds Code-to-Cloud Coverage for End-to-End Asset Traceability

Palo Alto Networks introduced Code-to-Cloud Coverage in Cortex Cloud, measuring bidirectional traceability from source code to running cloud assets and flagging coverage gaps. It links repositories, CI/CD pipelines, build artifacts, and runtime assets through an Asset Lineage Graph, using AI-assisted analysis of CI/CD logs and YOR tags to preserve IaC relationships without exposing Terraform state secrets. A new dashboard and Unified Asset Inventory tab show where lineage is complete or missing. Cortex Cloud was also named an Overall Leader in KuppingerCole's 2026 Software Supply Chain Security Report.

Source: <https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/cloud-security/code-to-cloud-tracing-dashboard/>

ANNOUNCEMENT**Palo Alto Networks**

2026-08-27

Palo Alto Networks Stock Jumps 11% on Reports of Renewed Acquisition Hunt

Palo Alto Networks shares rose roughly 11% amid reports the company is moving back into aggressive acquisition mode after failed runs at Okta and Datadog. Coverage names observability vendor Cribl (about \$3.5B valuation, ~\$200M ARR growing 70%) and AI-driven data platform ClickHouse (over \$250M ARR, ~\$15B private value) as leading targets, with Cribl seen as the more affordable fit against Palo Alto's 23.6x price-to-sales multiple. The reporting is speculative but signals continued platform-expansion M&A appetite in data and observability adjacencies.

Source: <https://www.fool.com/investing/2026/08/27/why-palo-alto-networks-stock-just-popped/>

THREAT INTEL**Palo Alto Networks**

2026-08-27

Unit 42 Warns Agentic AI Has Shifted the Balance of Power Toward Attackers

Palo Alto Networks' Unit 42 published "The State of AI-Enabled Malware: August 2026," describing an investigation where an attacker used an agentic framework to exploit 50 applications and additional weaknesses in under 10 hours — a pace SVP Sam Rubin called a generational shift. Analysis of 405 AI-related malware samples found only 12 on protected endpoints, with most appearing solely in sandboxes or VirusTotal, indicating today's AI-enabled malware is largely proof-of-concept. Unit 42 argues defenders need containment and remediation workflows built for machine-speed attacks.

Source: <https://cyberscoop.com/unit-42-palo-alto-networks-warning-agentic-ai-frontier-models/>

RESEARCH**Zscaler**

2026-08-27

Zscaler Mythos 2026 Study Finds Enterprise AI Tools Average Just 10.5/100 on AI Security

Zscaler's Mythos 2026 study of 38 large banking, healthcare, industrial, energy and tech organizations found every one exposed at least some corporate AI tooling to external attack, with AI-specific security scores averaging 10.5 out of 100 and no company above 15. Researchers found chatbots, MCP interfaces and inference APIs reachable online without authentication, often deployed by business units outside standard security review. Zscaler argues AI assets now sit inside the security perimeter and need governance, identity control and traffic inspection from day one.

Source: <https://asiatechjournal.com/the-race-to-adopt-ai-opens-doors-for-cybercriminals/>

ANALYST REPORT**Zscaler**

2026-08-27

Zscaler Shares Gap Up ~10% as JPMorgan Raises Target Amid Security Sector Re-Rating

Zscaler stock jumped roughly 10% on August 27 after JPMorgan raised its price target from \$205 to \$215 with an overweight rating, opening at \$179.12 and closing near \$187. Rosenblatt, Stifel, HC Wainwright, Citizens, Barclays and Deutsche Bank also reiterated or raised bullish targets, pushing consensus to Moderate Buy near \$216. Coverage tied the move to a broad security-sector re-rating into laggards ahead of Zscaler's Q4 FY26 report, with Evercore flagging valuation risk.

Source: <https://www.marketbeat.com/instant-alerts/price-zscaler-nasdaq-zs-shares-gap-up-following-analyst-upgrade-2026-08-27/>